

EPISODE 3 (SESSION 1)

Master the Beast

PRIMARY TEXT: GENESIS 4

What is the next right thing? And how do we do it?

When we work toward using our new perspective and examine this tragic story of two brothers, we realize the point isn't just about the sin and continued downfall of humanity, it is that even in our worst moments of falling prey to our desires, God is there. God walked with Adam and Eve in the garden *and* He walked with them out of it, believing they could do the next right thing. He talked and walked with their children. He met Cain, downcast, in all his anger, just as he had with his parents long before, and believed he also could do the next right thing.

In contrast, sin's desire was for Cain. And sin's desire for all of us—to fail, to stop trusting, and to start relying on ourselves instead of God—is a trap we all fall into. This beast is relentlessly trying to make you believe God has turned His back on humanity.

Sin is crouching at our door, or it may have come barreling through the door long ago. It wants to mess us up and make us believe we are beyond redemption—that we are no longer good enough, or never actually were, and it wants us to fail. It wants to rule over us. Yet, what does God believe? He believes, He knows, that you can master this beast.

**God still
believes in us.
Believes in you.**

God still believes in us. Believes in you.
God's position on you hasn't changed.
God's love for you hasn't changed.
God's desire to make you believe and remember that you are part
of His greatest creation *has not changed*.

There's another story, not in the Text, of two siblings—two sisters, actually. A story that captured the hearts of children through the silver screen. In it there is a song titled “Next Right Thing.” (Yes, if you weren't already thinking of it, the story is *Frozen 2*.)

Anna is downcast. She believes herself to be utterly alone and abandoned. She has two choices: give up, or just do the next right thing.

*... So I'll walk through this night
Stumbling blindly toward the light
And do the next right thing
And with the dawn, what comes then
When it's clear that everything will never be the same again?
Then I'll make the choice
To hear that voice
And do the next right thing*

**“... hear that
voice and do
the next right
thing”**

In the end, Anna chooses to take a step to do the next right thing by listening to the voice that was still with her, and the reality that awaits her is so much better than the one she is stuck in while downcast in grief and defeat. In BEMA terms, she trusts the story.

Can we?

Cain's story invites you to trust that there is a better and truer reality than the one you may think you are trapped in. You are a human being, beloved by God, so the challenge now is to let goodness rule you rather than desire, despair, and doubt. That is the next step. That is doing the next right thing, even if it means closing your eyes and trusting the outcome to God.

**the challenge now
is to let goodness
rule you**

Yes. You could have done better with that coworker last week or been more patient with your child this morning or made better decisions years ago that led you to where you sit now. So, do better tomorrow. Do better now. Trust that God is enough. Trust that He made you good enough, and do the next right thing—now.

PRAYER

*God,
Some days I forget where the Story begins.
The very beginning, when you call me Very Good.
Anxiety strikes. Desires abound.
And my trust in the Story wavers.
Yet, your love is ever present, without limits.
Thank you for believing that I have the potential
to be the person you created me to be—not
mastered by fear and shame, but able and ready to
do the next right thing.
Amen.*

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 3

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What piece of Genesis 4 could you meditate over and memorize this week? (Check out our YouVersion Reading Plans to help guide you.)



COMMUNITY

What intentional relationships help you practice unity and goodness over competition and desire? Who have you surrounded yourself with to remind yourself you are not alone and that you can master the beast?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who would be impacted by the reminder that God's position on them hasn't changed? How might you meet people where they are and have God use you to encourage them to master desire and pursue the next right thing?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? Remember, questions are good! Questions were/are the point. What are you still wrestling with, and why? How can you wrestle with fear and insecurity to better trust the story?



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*True success is developing intimacy with God, and **part of that intimacy is believing that God has not given up on or left you.** God knows your worth and wants you to remember it. What spaces do you have, or could you create, for God to enter into to help you remember this and challenge you to do the next right thing? Is this sacred devotional time, small groups, prayer, other spiritual disciplines?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world. And so often it is these young adults who give up on faith because they are told or somehow believe they are too far gone to be loved by God. **How can you remind young people of the goodness God has spoken over them?** How could you remind them that God's position on them has not changed, and help them realize how to do the next right thing?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Do you treat and see those at your "work" in the goodness God sees them in? Do we see others in their mistakes, or do we see them in the image God created them? How we bring life to others is something God says is central to our presence in the world—and believing in their ability to do better or do the next right thing is also characterized so heavily in the person of Jesus. The way we manage employees and interact with customers or coworkers says a lot about the God we believe in and what that God believes about the people we encounter. **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters—and so does the belief in the potential of ourselves and others in this space.***